

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Tiramisu

A velvet, coffee-soaked classic: generous mascarpone, bitter cocoa and a cool overnight rest. This is the dessert that feels like the final warm chord after a long studio session.

Serves 8	Prep 30 min	Rest 6-12 h	Style Creamy / coffee / no-bake
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TheFAB studio note

The secret is restraint: do not drown the biscuits, do not overwork the mascarpone, and let time do the mixing. Serve cold, with espresso or a small glass of Marsala.

Ingredients

- 500 g mascarpone, very cold
- 5 fresh eggs, separated
- 100 g caster sugar
- 250-300 g savoiardi / ladyfingers
- 350-400 ml strong espresso, cooled
- 2 tbsp Marsala, amaretto or dark rum, optional
- Unsweetened cocoa powder, for dusting
- 1 pinch fine salt
- A few shavings of dark chocolate, optional

Method

- 1 Make the coffee first so it can cool fully. Add the Marsala or amaretto if using.
- 2 Whisk the egg yolks with the sugar until pale, thick and creamy. Fold in the mascarpone until smooth.
- 3 Whisk the egg whites with a pinch of salt until firm. Fold them gently into the mascarpone cream, keeping as much air as possible.
- 4 Dip each ladyfinger very briefly in the coffee - one second per side is enough. Build one tight layer in a dish.
- 5 Spread over half the mascarpone cream, then repeat with a second layer of dipped biscuits and the remaining cream.
- 6 Cover and refrigerate for at least 6 hours, ideally overnight. Dust generously with cocoa just before serving.

Proposed wine pairing

A pairing designed to support the main character of the dish rather than overpower it.

Best match	Vin Santo del Chianti or Marsala Superiore Dolce.
Also works	Moscato d'Asti for a lighter, fresher finish; Recioto della Valpolicella if you want more intensity.
Why it works	The wine should be at least as sweet as the dessert. Nutty, dried-fruit notes echo the coffee, cocoa and mascarpone.
Serving note	Serve well chilled in small glasses. Avoid dry red wine: it will taste bitter next to the cocoa and sugar.

Personal adjustment: choose a bottle you would happily drink even without the dish. Pairing should amplify pleasure, not become an exam.